

FAITHFUL PATH

The Christian Spiritual Reset

A guided retreat to overcome burnout, hear God clearly, and renew your faith

Workbook

This workbook belongs to

Retreat dates

Richmond Kobe · faithfulpathcommunity.com

How to use this workbook

This workbook holds every page you will write on during the course. On the retreat itself you need three things: this workbook, the Retreat Session Guide (a separate, lighter document with each session's teaching, guided prayer, and exercise instructions), and your Bible. Print the workbook single-sided or double-sided as you prefer; the cut-out cards and a spare emergency card are on the last pages so they can be removed without losing anything.

If you need more room anywhere, continue in your journal and write the page number in the margin.

The pages follow the course in order. The preparation pages (readiness, format, intention, boundary, packing, emergency card, schedule) are completed before you leave. The ten session pages are used during the retreat. The pages after them are for the thirty days at home.

Three things to remember.

- ☐ Nothing here is graded. A blank line is an honest answer.
- ☐ Any exercise may be shortened, paused, or left. The sessions are offered, not assigned.
- ☐ If anything brings up more than you can safely hold, stop the exercise. Stand up, go outside if it is safe, orient yourself to the room, and contact your support person. If you are in danger or cannot remain safe, contact your local emergency number. This workbook is not monitored by anyone.

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Personal Readiness Check-in

Not a test, not scored. It helps you notice what deserves attention and may point you toward support before you begin. If you are in immediate danger, call your local emergency number now.

What have you experienced during the past month? Mark everything that applies. *(mark all that apply)*

- ☐ Persistent exhaustion
- ☐ Loss of interest or enjoyment
- ☐ Irritability or resentment
- ☐ Difficulty concentrating
- ☐ Prayer or Scripture feeling empty
- ☐ Unexpected tears or emotional reactions
- ☐ Feeling numb or detached
- ☐ Difficulty functioning at work or home
- ☐ Thoughts of wanting to disappear or not be alive

How long has this been happening? *(choose one)*

- ☐ Less than two weeks
- ☐ Two weeks or longer
- ☐ Several months
- ☐ I am not sure

How much is it affecting ordinary life? *(choose one)*

- ☐ I am functioning normally
- ☐ Some responsibilities are becoming difficult
- ☐ My work, relationships, sleep, eating, or self-care are significantly affected
- ☐ I am struggling to manage ordinary responsibilities
- ☐ I am struggling to remain safe

Do you feel safe being alone for an extended period? *(choose one)*

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ I am uncertain
- ☐ No

What your answers suggest

If you marked thoughts of wanting to disappear or not be alive, "I am struggling to remain safe", or "No" to feeling safe alone: please get support before anything else. Tell a trusted person today and contact a doctor, a mental-health professional, or a crisis service. If you may act on those thoughts or cannot keep yourself safe, contact your local emergency number now. The retreat will still be here when you are safe.

If it has lasted two weeks or longer and is significantly affecting ordinary life, or you are struggling to manage ordinary responsibilities: speak with a doctor or counsellor before you retreat, and choose path 2, 3 or 4 on the next page.

If you are uncertain about being alone, or several things are difficult: you can still take this retreat, but plan it with support and consider a shorter or at-home format.

Otherwise: your answers suggest tiredness rather than crisis. Carry on with the preparation.

What I will do with this

Your retreat format and your path

No.	Format	Length	Best for
1	Three-Day Christian Renewal Retreat	3 days	A full individual retreat
2	One-Day Retreat With God	8–9 hours	One protected day
3	Three-Hour Spiritual Reset	3 hours	An immediate pause
4	At-Home Retreat	8 or 12 days	Ongoing home responsibilities
5	Retreat for Couples	3 days	Two personal retreats taken together
6	Small-Group and Church Retreat	Weekend or weekly	A facilitated community setting
7	Retreat for Pastors and Christian Leaders	3 days	Ministry-specific burnout

The format I am choosing, and why

Length, location, and dates

The seven questions for my location

- ☐ Can I have protected time here?
- ☐ Does it help me feel safe and settled?
- ☐ Can I sleep well here?
- ☐ Can I eat simply here?
- ☐ Can I control my connectivity without losing access to help?
- ☐ Can it support my physical needs, including accessibility and medication?
- ☐ Can I afford it without stress?

My path (Lesson 5)

- ☐ Proceed independently. I feel stable, safe alone, and able to pause when needed.
- ☐ Proceed with support. I will arrange regular contact with a trusted person or professional during the retreat.
- ☐ Use an adapted format. I will choose the shorter, guided, or group version.
- ☐ Postpone for now. I will seek professional, medical, crisis, or safety support first.

The person I will call if a session becomes too much, and how I reach them

My intention

One honest page. It is a request, not a demand, and it can change. Bring it to Session One.

What I am carrying (*a few sentences: the situation I am coming from*)

What I am asking (*one sentence, addressed to God, in plain words*)

What I have not said (*the hidden hope or fear, if there is one*)

What I am releasing (*one sentence surrendering my demand for a particular outcome*)

If you cannot find an intention: "I do not know what I need. I only know I need to stop and be with you." That is complete.

Digital Boundary Agreement

Fill this in before you leave, and test the arrangement by having your emergency contact call you while it is active.

For my retreat from _____ to _____, I will use the following arrangement (tick one):

- ☐ Emergency-call option: cellular service remains on, but Focus or Do Not Disturb allows calls only from _____.
- ☐ Scheduled-check option: the phone remains disconnected except for checks at _____.
- ☐ Property-contact option: my emergency contact will call _____, who can reach me at the retreat location.

I tested this arrangement on _____. My emergency contact is _____, and we have agreed what counts as an emergency.

What counts as a genuine emergency, in one sentence we both know

I have told _____ and _____ that I will be away and who to contact if something urgent comes up.

Music and other screens: what I am leaving off, and the one exception if any

Signed: _____ Date: _____

Retreat Packing Checklist

Tick it off before you leave. Items marked (optional) are just that.

Sessions and reflection

- ☐ Bible, printed or prepared
- ☐ This course or printed session lessons from Module 4
- ☐ Journal (or accessible alternative) and two pens
- ☐ Lesson 4 check-in, Lesson 7 intention, Lesson 8 notes
- ☐ Timer or watch
- ☐ Index cards or loose paper
- ☐ Settling object (optional)

Medication and health

- ☐ All regular medication, with extra
- ☐ Prescriptions, supplies, or devices
- ☐ Essential medical information, accessible in an emergency
- ☐ Accessibility aids and medical equipment

Clothing and sleep

- ☐ Layered clothes for the season
- ☐ Walking shoes
- ☐ Pillow, earplugs, eye mask (optional)
- ☐ Outdoor items: sunscreen, hat, repellent, rain protection, first-aid kit

Personal care and accessibility

- ☐ Toothbrush, toothpaste, soap, deodorant
- ☐ Towel, if not provided
- ☐ Menstrual products, if needed
- ☐ Glasses, contact-lens supplies, hearing-aid batteries

Food and water

- ☐ Simple food meeting your needs (see Lesson 11)
- ☐ Refillable water bottle

Safety, communication, and transport

- ☐ Phone, prepared and tested
- ☐ Charger and power bank
- ☐ Paper card: address, emergency contact, host, doctor, emergency number
- ☐ Identification and booking details
- ☐ Cash or card
- ☐ Transport confirmed both ways

Location-specific

- ☐ Bedding and towels, if not provided
- ☐ Cooking equipment, if self-catering
- ☐ Keys or entry code

Leave behind

- ☐ Work and work devices
- ☐ Unfinished projects (completed, delegated, or rescheduled)
- ☐ Extra books
- ☐ Objects that create pressure
- ☐ Guilt acknowledged and addressed using Lesson 2

Emergency Information Card

Fill in by hand and keep it in your journal or pocket. If your phone fails, this card is your backup. Cut along the dashed line if you want to carry it separately.

Where I am staying

Address

**Property, host, or retreat-centre
contact**

My emergency contact and phone

**What counts as an emergency
(agreed)**

My doctor and phone

**Emergency services number in
this country**

Crisis helpline in this country

**Essential medical information for
responders**

(serious allergies, conditions, essential
medication)

Retreat dates

**Person who knows my plan and
dates**

Crisis lines by country: findahelpline.com. If you are in immediate danger, call the local emergency number.

My retreat schedule

Copy the timetable of the program you chose, adjusted to your own start times, meals and rest. Leave gaps. The retreat is not a timetable to keep up with.

	Day 1	Day 2	Day 3
Morning			
Midday			
Afternoon			
Evening			
Session Five decision			
Notes			

Shorter formats: use the Day 1 column for the one-day retreat or three-hour reset; use the rows as days for the at-home retreat.

Come As You Are

Central passage: Luke 15:11–24

Anchor phrase: "While he was still a long way off, his father saw him." Or, if you prefer something shorter: "I am here."

Before the session

Keep your honest sentence (Lesson 1), your check-in (Lesson 4), and your intention (Lesson 7) here.

Self-assessment

Answer these in your journal, briefly. This is a check-in, not a test.

1. How is your body right now? Tired, restless, tense, heavy, numb, calm? Name it without fixing it.

2. How is your mind? Racing, foggy, anxious, blank, quietly sad?

3. What speech have you prepared? In other words, what have you been planning to prove, achieve, or perform during these days so that the retreat will count?

4. Look back at your Lesson 4 check-in. Does it still describe you today? What has changed since you wrote it, if anything?

Silence

Length I chose: _____ minutes. Form: still / moving / supported. Eyes: open / closed. How it went: _____

Journaling

1. What did you notice during the silence? Thoughts, feelings, physical sensations, nothing in particular. Write it down without interpreting it.

2. The father ran. What is your honest reaction to the idea that God is not waiting for you to arrive properly, but is already moving toward you in compassion? Relief, suspicion, disbelief, indifference? Write the true answer.

3. The son planned to be a servant rather than a son. Where in your life, or your faith, have you been trying to be useful instead of being received?

4. Finish this sentence, and do not think about it too long: "The thing I most need to tell God honestly at the start of this retreat is..."

Practical exercise

Follow the instructions for this session in the Retreat Session Guide. Write here.

The cards I am sealing in the envelope (ordinary, non-urgent demands only; nothing that needs attention now)

Envelope sealed on: _____ To be opened on Day 3.

Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

I have come as I am. I am seen from a long way off, with compassion. I do not have to earn these days. During this retreat, I will practise laying down performance, and I will begin learning a different way to live when I return.

Be Still and Become Present

Central passage: Psalm 46

Anchor phrase: "Be still, and know that I am God." Or, shorter: "God is here."

Self-assessment

Briefly, in your journal:

1. Right now, where is your attention? In this room, or somewhere else? If somewhere else, where: the past, the future, another place, another person?

2. When you try to bring your attention back to now, what pulls it away again? Name the strongest pull.

3. On a scale from "mostly attentive to this room" to "strongly pulled elsewhere," where would you place yourself? No right answer.

4. What situation currently feels unstable, loud, or beyond your control? Name it in one line without analysing or solving it. If you feel unreal, disconnected from your body, unable to recognise where you are, or as though you are reliving another time, pause the session and use the grounding and support guidance from Lesson 5.

Silence

Length I chose: _____ minutes. Form: still / moving / supported. Eyes: open / closed. How it went: _____

Journaling

1. Where did your attention go during the silence? List the places. Which one did it return to most often?

2. When have you recognised, or felt, God's help in your life? If you cannot identify such a time, say so honestly. Your inability to recall an experience does not make the psalm's declaration untrue, and Session Seven will return to this.

3. The disciples were afraid because the boat was filling. What reasonable fear makes it difficult for you to remember or trust that Christ remains with you?

4. Finish this sentence: "If I gave this present moment my attention without trying to solve the past or anticipate the future, I would notice..."

Practical exercise

Follow the instructions for this session in the Retreat Session Guide. Write here.

Walking silence: what I noticed with each sense, and where my attention kept going

Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

God is a very present help. The storm is real, and Christ is with me in it. I am learning to be here, in this hour, in this place. Every time I wander, I will come back.

Release What You Are Carrying

Central passage: Matthew 11:28–30

Anchor phrase: "Come to me, and I will give you rest." Or, shorter: "Gentle and lowly in heart."

Self-assessment

In your journal, make a list. Take ten minutes or more. Write down everything you are carrying right now: responsibilities, worries, fears, hopes you are holding for other people, expectations, guilt, unresolved situations. Do not sort them yet. Include the things that feel too small to mention. Include what you can name safely; if something feels too large, write only a general word such as "grief," "harm," or "something for professional support." You do not need to record details.

When the list is done, read it once, and then answer:

1. How long is the list? Did it surprise you?

2. Which item on it has been there longest?

3. Which item most affects your daily capacity? What kind of support, change, or faithful response might make it more manageable?

Silence

Length I chose: _____ minutes. Form: still / moving / supported. Eyes: open / closed. How it went: _____

Journaling

1. Go back through your list and mark each item with one or more of these letters. An item can carry more than one; "A/E" might mean take the action that belongs to me and entrust the result.

2. Look at the items marked E. What have you been trying to guarantee? Where did the sense that it was yours to guarantee come from?

3. Look at the items marked S. For each, name the kind of help it needs: a friend, a spouse, a pastor, a doctor, a counsellor, a colleague, a professional service.

4. Look at the items marked ?. For each, name the right kind of guidance. A pastor or counsellor is not the correct authority for every burden; some need a doctor or mental-health professional, a domestic-abuse specialist, a safeguarding leader, a lawyer or financial adviser, an employer or HR representative, or a trusted family member.

5. Was anything on the list laid on you in God's name that Jesus might describe as a heavy burden, hard to bear? Write about it honestly. If you are not sure, say so.

Practical exercise

Follow the instructions for this session in the *Retreat Session Guide*. Write here.

A = act, S = share, E = entrust, ? = seek counsel or qualified help. Then write the cards (at the back of this workbook).

What I am carrying	A / S / E / ?	Kind of help, or next step

Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

I have come to Christ, who gives rest. I release my demand to control what is beyond me. I will seek help with what should be shared. I will take the next faithful step in what belongs to me. Christ is gentle and humble in heart, and I am learning his way.

Lament, Grief, and Honest Prayer

Central passage: Psalm 13

Anchor phrase: "How long, O LORD?" Or, if that is too raw today: "Consider and answer me."

Self-assessment

In your journal, gently:

1. Is there a loss in your life that has received little space, support, or acknowledgment? Name it in a word or a phrase, or in a general word if a specific one is too much.

2. Is there something about which you feel angry, disappointed, confused, or abandoned in relation to God? Write it down without softening it.

3. When you read Psalm 13's questions, which one is closest to your own: forgetting, hiding, sorrow, an enemy prevailing, or another phrase from the psalm?

4. What have you been told, or told yourself, about whether it is acceptable to pray like this? If any answer brings up more than you can hold, stop here, and use the pause guidance from Lesson 5. You can return to the rest of the session later, or not at all.

Silence

Length I chose: _____ minutes. Form: still / moving / supported. Eyes: open / closed. How it went: _____

Journaling

1. What did you find yourself grieving, or angry about, during the silence? Write it in whatever detail feels safe.

2. Psalm 13 moves through address, complaint, petition, and trust. Which of those four have you been skipping in your own prayers? Which have you been stuck in?

3. What loss have you felt unable or unwilling to grieve openly, because you believed you should be past it, or because hope seemed to forbid sorrow? Tears are one expression of grief, not the measure of whether grief is real.

4. Write one sentence that begins "God, I do not understand why..." and finish it truthfully.

Practical exercise

Follow the instructions for this session in the Retreat Session Guide. Write here.

My lament, in the shape of Psalm 13. Use only the parts you can pray honestly.

Address: who I am speaking to

Complaint: what I am honestly saying is wrong

Request: what I am asking for

Trust: what I can still say about God, if anything today

If the last part will not come, leave it empty. You do not have the last verses yet.

Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

I have spoken as honestly as I can today. My grief does not disqualify me from God's presence. I do not have to be finished with sorrow in order to pray. Where trust is difficult, I am willing to remain with one honest word, or to receive support until words return.

Confession and Grace

Central passage: Psalm 51:1–12

Anchor phrase: "According to your steadfast love." Or, shorter: "Have mercy on me."

Self-assessment

Gently, in your journal. This is a review of a season, not a hunt.

1. Has a repeated choice or relational pattern become clearer during the retreat? If so, name it.

2. Did that pattern involve actual wrongdoing, a human limitation, a health or trauma response, or some combination? Use the five questions above.

3. Who was affected, and what impact can you responsibly acknowledge?

4. What does Psalm 51:1 reveal about the mercy to which you are bringing this? Write it before you write anything else. If nothing comes, do not manufacture it. Some readers will find that the honest answer is "I do not see a pattern," and that is an acceptable answer. Move to the prayer.

Silence

Length I chose: _____ minutes. Form: still / moving / supported. Eyes: open / closed. How it went: _____

Journaling

1. What, if anything, surfaced during the silence? Write it plainly, without excuse and without exaggeration, and then apply the five questions to it.

2. David's consequences did not disappear when he was forgiven. Is there any repair, apology, or accountability that your confession points toward once you are home? Write what it is and who it involves. If it is serious in the way described above, write only the name of the qualified person you will consult.

3. Has concealment, defensiveness, or refusal to take responsibility affected your ability to love someone well? If so, how?

4. If I began living from the assurance of forgiveness while still accepting appropriate consequences, one possible change would be...

Practical exercise

Follow the instructions for this session in the Retreat Session Guide. Write here.

What I have seen, and what I confess

Repair: what, to whom, and whether it is safe and wise to make contact

Accountability: who I will tell, and when

The assurance I am receiving (1 John 1:9), in my own words

Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

God's steadfast love is revealed before my confession begins. I have named what I can see, without exaggeration or excuse. In Christ, forgiveness rests on God's faithfulness, not the intensity of my feelings. I will accept both mercy and the faithful actions that accountability requires. (Optional:) Forgiven much, I am free to love much.

Forgiving Others and Yourself

Central passage: Matthew 18:21–35

Anchor phrase: "Into your hands I place this wound." Or: "God sees and God cares." Or: "Show me the next faithful step."

Self-assessment

Gently, in your journal:

1. Is there a person whose actions still carry unresolved grief, anger, fear, or a desire for justice in you? Name them, or use an initial, or write nothing identifying.

2. Which of those responses needs grief, which needs protection, which needs accountability, and which may be moving toward release? Use the five movements.

3. Which parts of what you want depend on the other person? Which faithful steps remain available to you even if they never respond as you hope?

4. Is there something you have been punishing yourself for that God has already forgiven, or that you have never brought to

him? If any of this brings up more than you can hold, stop, and defer the session. That is a legitimate decision.

Silence

Length I chose: _____ minutes. Form: still / moving / supported. Eyes: open / closed. How it went: _____

Journaling

1. What happened in the silence? Write it without interpreting it.

2. Which of the "release is not" statements did you most need to hear? Which have you been confusing with forgiveness, and how has that confusion kept you from it?

3. What safety measure, boundary, report, or consequence will remain in place whatever you release? Write it down. Naming it may make release possible.

4. If you have been punishing yourself, which of the four (conviction, shame, consequence, self- punishment) is actually at work? What would it mean to accept Romans 8:1 as the verdict?

Practical exercise

Follow the instructions for this session in the Retreat Session Guide. Write here.

What happened, named plainly (this stays private)

The boundaries I keep

What I am asking God to begin in me

The next safe and faithful step, only the next one

Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

I am not required to deny the wrong or abandon justice. I release, or ask for help releasing, personal vengeance. I will preserve the boundaries, truth, reporting, and accountability that remain necessary. I place what I cannot control into God's care. God's mercy does not require me to remain in danger.

Listening for God's Direction

Central passage: 1 Kings 19:9–18

Anchor phrase: "Speak, Lord, for your servant hears." Or, shorter: "Here I am."

Self-assessment

In your journal:

1. God asked Elijah, "What are you doing here?" Answer it for yourself, honestly, in a few sentences. Not why you came, but what you are actually doing here, now, on the third morning.

2. In the past, what have you understood as God's guidance? Looking back, what fruit, correction, confirmation, or later evidence helped you evaluate it?

3. Is there a decision, a direction, or a question you have been hoping this retreat would settle? Write it in one line.

4. What does Scripture already say about that matter, as far as you know? If you are not sure, write that down; it is the first thing to find out.

Silence

Length I chose: _____ minutes. Form: still / moving / supported. Eyes: open / closed. How it went: _____

Journaling

1. Write down, without editing, anything you sensed during the silence: a verse, a thought, a phrase, a picture, a direction, or nothing. Do not decide yet whether it was God.

2. Did anything seem corrective, encouraging, clarifying, or unresolved? Do not force one of these categories if nothing significant emerged.

3. For anything significant, go through the tests above and mark each one "supports," "raises concern," "not yet examined," or "requires qualified advice." Nothing is confirmed until those checks are complete, and several of them cannot be completed on a retreat.

4. Who is a mature, trustworthy Christian who knows Scripture, understands your situation, respects appropriate boundaries, and has no interest in controlling your decision? For medical, legal, financial, or abuse-related matters, who has the relevant competence? If you do not have such people, who could you begin to ask?

Practical exercise

Follow the instructions for this session in the Retreat Session Guide. Write here.

What I sensed, written without interpreting it

How I will test it (Lesson 24)

- ☐ Against Scripture, read in context
- ☐ Against the character and fruit of Christ
- ☐ Against the facts, checked with people who know
- ☐ With time: no irreversible action until after the review date
- ☐ With my Eli or a qualified adviser
- ☐ For safety, consent, justice and accountability
- ☐ For secrecy, superiority, urgency or immunity from challenge
- ☐ As a proportionate, reversible first step
- ☐ When I am rested enough to decide

Review date: _____

Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

God has spoken authoritatively in Scripture, and I will begin there. I have brought my question honestly without demanding an immediate answer. Any impression I recorded remains an impression until it has been tested. I will seek wise and appropriately qualified counsel. I will not use God's name to justify harm, haste, secrecy, or escape. If faithful responsibility calls me back, I will respond with wisdom, safety, and support.

Rediscovering Your Identity

Central passage: Matthew 3:13–17, followed by Matthew 4:1–11

Anchor phrase: "See what love the Father has given us." Or: "Abba, Father." If parental language is difficult for you because of your own history, use instead: "Nothing can separate me from the love of God in Christ."

Self-assessment

In your journal:

1. List the roles you hold: family, work, church, community. All of them, including the informal ones, like "the one who holds everyone together." This is not asking you to erase your relational or vocational identity; "parent," "pastor," "friend," and "neighbour" describe real relationships and responsibilities. The question is whether any one role has become the sole measure of your worth.

2. Beside each, mark honestly how much of your sense of worth rests on it. A little, some, or a great deal.

3. Which role, if it ended tomorrow, would leave you least sure who you are?

4. If you could not mention achievements, productivity, income, influence, or how useful you are to others, what would you want someone to understand about you? Try to write two sentences.

Silence

Length I chose: _____ minutes. Form: still / moving / supported. Eyes: open / closed. How it went: _____

Journaling

1. What happened when you tried to be rather than do in the silence? Restlessness, relief, discomfort, blankness? Write it down.

2. The tempter's challenge carried the implication, "Prove who you are on these terms." Where have you been trying to prove your worth through achievement, usefulness, visibility, or sacrifice?

3. Which role could you hold with less fear or compulsion if you trusted that it was not the source of your worth? Is there any optional responsibility that may need to be reduced, delegated, or released?

4. Is there a loss of role, past or approaching, that you have been treating as a loss of self? Name it.

Practical exercise

Follow the instructions for this session in the Retreat Session Guide. Write here.

What I do	What matters about this role	What remains true beyond this role

I am loved before I am useful. What that changes this week

Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

Before Jesus began his work, the Father called him beloved; through him, I am called God's child. What I do rests on who I am, not the other way round. My roles matter, and they are not the measure of my worth. I am not a slave who must stay useful. I am a child who is loved.

Renewing Your Purpose

Central passage: John 21:15–19

Anchor phrase: "Lord, you know everything." Or, if it is honest today: "Lord, you know that I love you."

Self-assessment

In your journal:

1. Did your main role once feel meaningful or life-giving? If so, what mattered about it then? If it never did, what originally led you into it?

2. Where has care become emotionally depleted or mechanically performed? Be specific: which tasks, which relationships, which parts of the role.

3. Who is presently within your legitimate sphere of care or responsibility? Who is not?

4. Honestly: if Jesus asked you "Do you love me?" today, what would you say? Write the true answer, including "I am not sure" if that is it. Do not turn this into a test of whether your feelings are intense or pure enough. In Scripture, love includes allegiance, trust, obedience, desire, and return, not uninterrupted emotional warmth.

Silence

Length I chose: _____ minutes. Form: still / moving / supported. Eyes: open / closed. How it went: _____

Journaling

1. What rose in the silence when the question was asked?

2. Is there a failure that you have treated as proof that grace, growth, or faithful participation are no longer possible? Write it down, and write what this passage says to it. Then, honestly: what restoration may be possible, and what roles may still remain inappropriate or require accountability?

3. Of the people within your care, where has care become depleted? What support, boundary, rest, or small act of attention might help you care more humanely this week?

4. Is any responsibility being sustained mainly by fear, approval- seeking, or the need to prove yourself? What other legitimate reasons remain? Most motives are mixed; mark it for discernment rather than judging it from motive alone.

Practical exercise

Follow the instructions for this session in the Retreat Session Guide. Write here.

My purpose statement for this season (one or two sentences)

The one faithful thing I will do

What may need to narrow or end (to be tested, not acted on)

What I have taken on through fear, pressure, or the need to be indispensable

Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

My purpose begins in relationship with Christ, not in proving my worth. I will practise love within the responsibilities and limits of this season. What has become unsustainable, I will bring into honest discernment. I do not have to change the world. I can take one faithful step.

Returning With a New Rhythm

Central passage: 1 Kings 19:19–21, followed by Luke 10:17–20

Anchor phrase: "Go, return on your way." Or: "I am not alone."

Self-assessment

In your journal:

1. Reread the three questions you answered at the end of Lesson 1, and your answers. Then reread your intention from Lesson 7, all four parts. Without forcing it: what has shifted, what has become clearer, and what may still need attention, support, prayer, or discernment after you return? Write honestly, including "nothing yet" if that is true. Lesson 1 told you that you would read these again; this is not a test of whether the retreat worked.

2. Lay out the practical and discernment cards together. What do you notice? Is there a theme, a person who appears more than once, a concern that keeps returning? A repeated theme is worth noticing, but repetition alone does not prove that it is God's central message. It may indicate anxiety, an intrusive concern, an unmet need, or a genuine priority requiring further discernment.

3. Was there a moment, exercise, rest period, conversation, or passage that seems especially important? If nothing stands out yet, write that.

4. What are you afraid will happen when you get home?

Silence

Length I chose: _____ minutes. Form: still / moving / supported. Eyes: open / closed. How it went: _____

Journaling

1. What did you notice in the last silence?

2. Of everything that happened, what one thing do you most want to be true in a month's time? Write it as a sentence beginning "In a month, I hope..."

3. Who will you tell about the retreat, and what will you tell them? Who will you not tell yet, and why?

4. What is the next deliberate pause or form of support you need? It might be a three-hour reset, a day retreat, a counselling appointment, a Sabbath practice, or a protected hour. Write it down. A rhythm needs a next time.

Practical exercise

Follow the instructions for this session in the Retreat Session Guide. Write here.

One burden to entrust to God

One responsible action to take, and when

One person to involve, and what I will say

One sustainable rhythm to keep (what, when, where), and what I will do when I miss it

Optional sessions to revisit at home

Write the four onto the take-home cards at the back of this workbook. Then read the blessing.

Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

I came as honestly as I could, and grace met me here. I am returning with some clarity and some unfinished questions. I will not carry ordinary life alone. I take one small rhythm and one next faithful step. My retreat experience is not the measure of God's faithfulness. (Optional:) My name is written in heaven, and that is what I will rejoice in.

Testing Worksheet

One copy per direction you are testing. For each test, record a status: supports / raises concern / not yet examined / requires qualified advice.

What I sensed

Category

- ☐ Nothing significant
- ☐ A low-risk, reversible step
- ☐ A major, high-impact, or hard-to-reverse direction

Safety exception applies (immediate danger, abuse, urgent medical need, reporting duty, unpostponable deadline)? yes / no

Test	Notes	Status
1. Scripture, in context		
2. Character and fruit of Christ		
3. Facts it depends on, and whether checked		
4. Time given so far, and what has changed		
5. Advisers consulted, and what each said		
6. Safety, consent, justice, accountability		
7. Secrecy, superiority, urgency, immunity from challenge		
8. Proportionate, reversible first step		
9. My present condition to decide		

Testing begins: _____ Review on: _____

Verdict for now: act on the small step / not yet, revisit on the review date / let it go

Two-Week Plan

Begin with the minimum. Add the rest only if your present capacity allows.

Minimum, over two weeks

- ☐ One Act step: _____ done on _____
- ☐ One Share conversation, with: _____
- ☐ One Seek-counsel appointment or access step: _____
- ☐ Rhythm practised, imperfectly, on (days): _____
- ☐ Jethro questions answered: yes / not yet

The five Jethro questions

What am I doing that only I can do?

What could someone else do, if asked and trusted?

What does not need doing at all?

What am I doing because I am afraid of what happens if I stop?

What would this role look like if it were designed for a human being with limits?

If capacity allows

- ☐ A second Act step: _____
- ☐ A second Share conversation, with: _____
- ☐ One structural change requested from: _____ Result: _____
- ☐ Lesson 24 review date, if testing: _____

My rule for this season

One page. Three core lines. Leave the optional lines blank unless one of them is where the retreat pointed.

Date: _____

Regular ceasing and rest

Prayer and Scripture

One limit that protects my health or calling

One relationship I will tend (optional)

Additional commitment (optional)

When I miss something: I will resume at the next appropriate opportunity without punishment, compensation, or guilt.

Two-week check: _____ Three-month review: _____ Person I will share this with: _____

An example, deliberately unimpressive: Saturday noon to evening, no paid work or email, eat with family and walk, phone outside the bedroom; a psalm and five minutes of prayer at 7 a.m., Monday to Friday; laptop closed by 7 p.m.

30-day tracker

Tick the days you kept the rhythm. A missed day is resumed, not made up.

Week	Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5	Day 6	Day 7	This week
1: Landing Psalm 23								
2: Doing Psalm 62								
3: Shaping Psalm 27								
4: Settling Psalm 131								

Day 29–30: the review (next page). Next deliberate pause booked for: _____

Day 30 review

Sit down for an hour with your journal, your cards, your intention page, and your Lesson 1 sentence. Not to grade the month. To see it.

Grace received: where did I notice help, kindness, provision, truth, rest, or God's presence that I did not produce through effort?

The intention: what has become clearer, and what still needs attention?

My Lesson 1 sentence beside where I am now. Notice; do not force a conclusion.

The rhythm: how often did I keep it, what helped, what prevented it, and should it be kept, shrunk, moved, or replaced?

The cards: which became actions, conversations, help, or release? Which can be let go?

The unresolved: named, and left named.

The help: if Lesson 27 applied, did I act? (write "Not needed at this time" if it did not apply)

The four outcomes

One burden entrusted to God

One responsible step taken

One person involved

One sustainable rhythm kept

My next deliberate pause, and the date it is booked for

One dated paragraph: what this month has been

Go on your way, and go with others. Work when it is yours to work. Stop when it is time to stop. The world is held by God, not by you.

The Lord bless you and keep you.

Retreat cards

Cut along the dashed lines. Use your own words if they are truer than the prompts. Nothing after this page is needed once the cards are removed.

ENTRUST

I cannot control _____. I release my demand to guarantee the outcome. Show me any faithful action that still belongs to me.

ENTRUST

I cannot control _____. I release my demand to guarantee the outcome. Show me any faithful action that still belongs to me.

ENTRUST

I cannot control _____. I release my demand to guarantee the outcome. Show me any faithful action that still belongs to me.

SHARE

I need help carrying _____. The person or service I will approach is _____.

SHARE

I need help carrying _____. The person or service I will approach is _____.

ACT

The next faithful step within my responsibility is _____. I do not have to solve everything today.

ACT

The next faithful step within my responsibility is _____. I do not have to solve everything today.

ACT

The next faithful step within my responsibility is _____. I do not have to solve everything today.

SEEK COUNSEL

I will not make this decision alone. I will seek appropriate guidance from _____.

SEEK COUNSEL

I will not make this decision alone. I will seek appropriate guidance from _____.

WHAT I SENSE / TO TEST

What I sensed: _____. I will write it down, not act on it, and test it after the retreat.

WHAT I SENSE / TO TEST

What I sensed: _____. I will write it down, not act on it, and test it after the retreat.

TAKE HOME • ONE BURDEN TO ENTRUST

I am handing this to God, and I will not pick it up again this week: _____

TAKE HOME • ONE RESPONSIBLE ACTION

The one step I will take, and the date: _____

TAKE HOME • ONE PERSON TO INVOLVE

The person I will tell, ask, or share with, and what I will say:

TAKE HOME • ONE SUSTAINABLE RHYTHM

The rhythm I will keep, imperfectly: _____. When I miss it, I will start again the next day without guilt.

Emergency Information Card (spare copy)

Fill in by hand and carry it with you.

Where I am staying

Address

**Property, host, or retreat-centre
contact**

My emergency contact and phone

**What counts as an emergency
(agreed)**

My doctor and phone

**Emergency services number in
this country**

Crisis helpline in this country

**Essential medical information for
responders**

(serious allergies, conditions, essential
medication)

Retreat dates

**Person who knows my plan and
dates**